

## Topic 7 – UK in the 21st Century

A diverse range of cultures, identities and economies make up the patchwork of the UK. This topic poses questions about the changing nature of people's lives and work in the UK in the 21st century. It asks learners to consider some of the drivers for this

change. As new economic superpowers emerge, questions have been posed about the global significance of the UK. This will be investigated through a study of the UK's political and cultural connections with the rest of the world.

| 7.1. How is the UK changing in the 21st century?   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Scale      |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| a. What does the UK look like in the 21st century? | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Overview of human and physical geographical characteristics of the UK, including population density, land use, rainfall and relief, and significant issues associated with these characteristics, including water stress and housing shortages.</li> </ul> | N          |
| b. How is the UK's population changing?            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Overview of population trends in the UK since 2001, using population pyramids and migration statistics, to determine its position on the Demographic Transition Model.</li> </ul>                                                                          | N          |
|                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>An understanding of the causes, effects, spatial distribution and responses to an ageing population.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                            | N, R       |
|                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>A summary of the how the population structure and ethnic diversity of a named place of the UK has changed since 2001.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                           | R, L       |
| c. How is the UK's economy changing?               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Identify major economic changes in the UK since 2001 by examining changes in the job market including political priorities, changing employment sectors and working hours.</li> </ul>                                                                      | N, R, L    |
|                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Investigate the pattern of core UK economic hubs.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                               | N, F       |
|                                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Identify the changes in <b>one</b> economic hub and its significance to its region and the UK.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                  | N, R, L, F |
| 7.2 Is the UK losing its global significance?      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |            |
| a. What is the UK's political role in the world?   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Examine the UK's political role in <b>one</b> global conflict through its participation in international organisations.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                         | G, N       |
| b. How is the UK's cultural influence changing?    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Explore the UK's media exports and their global influence including television programmes and film.</li> <li>The contribution of ethnic groups to the cultural life of the UK through <b>one</b> of food, media or fashion.</li> </ul>                     | G, N       |